

Name:

Period:

This poem was written by the Harlem Renaissance author Langston Hughes. Knowing that, what will be the central topic for this poem? Who is the intended audience?

Underline the first line in each stanza. What is the speaker looking at in each one? Explain how the viewpoint changes.

## I look at the World by Langston Hughes

I look at the world  
From awakening eyes in a black face—  
And this is what I see:  
This fenced-off narrow space  
Assigned to me.

I look then at the silly walls  
Through dark eyes in a dark face—  
And this is what I know:  
That all these walls oppression builds  
Will have to go!

I look at my own body  
With eyes no longer blind—  
And I see that my own hands can make  
The world that's in my mind.  
Then let us hurry, comrades,  
The road to find.

Highlight with yellow all the synonyms and words that relate to the eye. Categorize the words you find. (i.e. How many nouns? verbs? etc.) What could those totals suggest?

Draw a line to the line(s) that reveal(s) the speaker's goal/desire.

Circle the word in the last stanza that indicates that the speaker wants to create unity with audience. Why does he call out to others instead of just going about his mission alone?



What scenes do you visualize in the first and last stanzas in the poem? What is the difference in mood?

What does the speaker mean in the third stanza when he says, "I see that my own hands can make the world that's in my mind"?

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The poem was written during the Civil Rights movement, so if we apply that lens to our understanding, we can see how the walls Hughes refers to are symbolic of those issues. However, looking back into that reading, what are the other walls that people might face?

What theme is conveyed in this poem? Take a look at the animation of the poem linked in Schoology before you answer.

**Text-to-Self Activity:** On the glasses document provided to you, it's your turn to "look at the world." On the left eye, write and illustrate what you want to see in/of the world. On the right eye, write and illustrate how you hope the world changes you. Then color/design the frames to fit your personality.

When you complete both sides of this document and the glasses activity, turn them in.